

Fantastic plastic

There are alternatives to buying cash for your travels. Debit and credit cards are widely accepted around the world, and they can be used to pay for things such as hotels, restaurants, and souvenirs. There are also prepaid debit cards, onto which you can put the amount of money you will need before you travel. You'll probably still need cash for smaller purchases and, just like at home, you can get this from an ATM using your debit or credit card. Unfortunately, this doesn't mean that you escape the cost of changing money. Your bank will likely charge for any payments you make in another currency, as well as using an exchange rate that is favorable to them, and this charge will also apply to any local currency you withdraw from an ATM.

You may even pay exchange costs without ever leaving home! If you buy things from another country online, for example, the seller will want to be paid in his or her own currency, and your bank will charge you for the transaction. If you are running a business with customers or suppliers in other countries, the cost of accepting or making payments in different currencies must be taken into account, and is reflected in the prices charged.



BUREAUX DE CHANGE

In addition to banks, and some post offices, there are companies that specialize in changing money. These currency exchanges, or *bureaux de change*, operate especially in tourist areas and city centers, and at airports and railway stations. They usually

display a list of the currencies they deal with, alongside the prices, in the local currency, at which they buy and sell them.



The euro coins minted in various countries look different, but can be used anywhere in the Eurozone.

See also: [Where did the MONEY go?](#)